

# Rain Water Harvesting: Why Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) Matters?

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FAO's "Rain Water Harvesting

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# Introduction

- “Rainwater harvesting is not about rainwater technologies.... it is about people. And it is about rainwater technologies .. only as far as rainwater technologies can serve the needs of people (**poor women, youths and men**)”
- Rainwater harvesting solutions should solve the citizens priorities for gendered outcomes – impact
- *Women face barriers in accessing RWH*

# Definitions

- Gender refers to the roles and responsibilities that society ascribes to men, women and different age groups which are rooted in culture.
- Gender differences, class, caste and race determine the roles, power, resources for males and females, access to services, opportunities, information.
- Intersectionality lens: overlapping and interdependent systems of discrimination or disadvantage.
- Gender is about power relationships which can change over time.

# Gender context

- It is the ability to recognise gender issues i.e. women's, youths, girls' men's and boys' distinct perceptions and interests/needs, priorities arising from their gender role (that which they are expected to do by society).
- What we do in the world reflects what we know about it, and what we know about it depends on how we go about knowing, or in other words when thinking about change we should start by thinking about thinking – framing.

Gender is not the same as sex (male of female)





# Gender Transformative

## GENDER EQUALITY CONTINUUM TOOL

Ignores:

- the set of economic/social/political roles, rights, entitlements, responsibilities, obligations and associated with being female & male
- power dynamics between and among men & women, boys & girls

**Gender Blind**



**Gender Aware**

- Examines and addresses these gender considerations and adopts an approach along the continuum

**Exploitative**

Reinforces or takes advantage of gender inequalities and stereotypes

**Accommodating**

Works around existing gender differences and inequalities

**Transformative**

- Fosters critical examination of gender norms\* and dynamics
- Strengthens or creates systems\* that support gender equality
- Strengthens or creates equitable gender norms and dynamics
- Changes inequitable gender norms and dynamics

**GOAL**

**Gender Equality and better development outcomes**



\* Norms encompass attitudes and practices

\* A system consists of a set of interacting structures, practices, and relations



# Kenya Laikipia (Photos Radhika)





# Jordan



# Why Gender Matters in RWH?

- **Land ownership** – women own less land (Complex gender gaps in landownership – Doss 2015)  
Bin Agrawal – lack of access to, ownership of, control over property –setback for women
- **Ability to make choices** - (Kabeer 2005) – where to have RWH, what to do with the water?
- **50-60% of sub-Saharan labour force are women** (FAO 2011, 2010; COMESA) – implications on labour demand (reproductive, productive and community roles)
- Less access to innovations and technologies (Quisumbing et al., 2001)
- Women have lesser **access to inputs** than men (FAO 2011).



## Why Gender Matters in RWH? (cont'd)

- **Female farmers produce less than male farmers** due to unfavorable context (IFPRI 2010) – how can they benefit from RWH?
- **Closing gender gap** would result in significant gains.
- **SDG5** – Gender and equality - Poverty and Food security are mutually reinforcing (FAO 2011).
- Female farmers harvest **20-30% less yield** due to lower use of inputs.
- **Less access to information** and technologies (Regassa et al., 2012)



## Why Gender Matters in RWH? (cont'd)

- What are the productivity increase implications for labor requirements?
- Technological and institutional solutions – their relevance and usefulness for men and women – RWH where do we focus? Differential impacts on men and women.
- Different vulnerabilities/capacities - Women and men's needs and interests – RWH technological innovations are not gender neutral

## Why Gender Matters in RWH? (cont'd)

- Access to, use management of, ownership – (Joshi *et al.*, 2022)
- Hydro-Patriarchy – technological land and water management – masculinities .
- Inclusivity and functionality (Zwarteveen and Neupane 1995)

# Sex and Age Disaggregated Data

- Sex and age-disaggregated data should be collected and analysed to assess the effect of any intervention.
- Sex disaggregated data on the at risk populations such as women, girls, people living with disabilities, orphans and vulnerable children should be collected to ensure that their specific RWH needs are being addressed.
- Baselines,
- Good data - good gendered decisions.



# Conclusion

- Gender is important in RWH
- Who are we: *Reaching, Accessing resources and benefits, Empowering, Transformed* – (Kleiber et al. 2018)
- Technologies, such as RWH, are not gender neutral
- It is about good and inclusive development
- No one will be left behind

Thank you

